

LEVEL 2

WRITING WITH A BEGINNING, MIDDLE, AND END

BEGINNING: You set the stage for the story by introducing your character and make the readers familiar with him or her. You should also include a setting (the place where the story happens), and tell your readers about the situation (problem). It gives your readers an idea of what kind of world they are reading about and the main character, whom we will be following throughout the story. Your character will gain something or lose something due to the problem you presented. Your character must solve the problem.

MIDDLE: Your character struggles with the problem and tries to finish his or her goal but doesn't fully do so yet. This is where the main action happens. Your character must face the main problem, even though it's hard. This part of the story builds stress on your character and makes the readers wonder how and if the character will be able to solve the problem.

END: This is where your character finds a way to resolve (solve) the problem, and the story is concluded (finished). It's the part where the character finds a solution, learns a lesson, or comes to a new understanding of his or her situation. This is where the story feels complete. The story ends here. The reader feels satisfied with the ending.

LEVEL 1

WRITING WITH A BEGINNING, MIDDLE, AND END

BEGINNING: This is where you write about your character and the world that he or she lives in. Then, you write about a problem that appears for your character.

MIDDLE: This is where your character tries to solve the problem. It's okay if he or she doesn't solve the problem on the first try! Remember that even good characters can make mistakes.

END: This is where your character solves the problem! The story is finished here. Ask yourself if your character learns a lesson.

EXAMPLE: Once upon a time, there was a bear named Lia. She lived deep in the woods, where trees grew, with sweet, purple berries. Lia loved those purple berries. But whenever she tried to reach up into a tree to grab a pawful of berries, she realized she was too short. When she tried to climb the trees, she found that she was too heavy, and the trees were too thin. Shaking the tree back and forth did not make many berries fall. And the berries that fell to the ground were never as yummy as freshly-picked ones. Lia was very sad about this. One day, she saw a raccoon named Rosie climb into a purple-berry tree and easily pick some of those delicious berries. She called up to Rosie. "Hello, Mrs. Rosie!"

"Hello, Miss Lia!" she called back, through a mouthful of berries.

"Do you think you would be willing to bring some of those berries down to me so I can have some, too? They are very yummy but I can't get many."

Rosie the raccoon thought for a moment. She finally said, "Well, how about this: I can bring you as many berries as you want, as long as you are willing to share your den with me this Winter. It is going to get chilly soon, and I need somewhere to live during the cold, snowy Winter. I hear that your den is nice and cozy, even when it's very cold outside."

Lia the bear scratched her ear for a moment, and then said, "That sounds fair to me!"

Rosie the raccoon brought an armful of berries down the tree. They gently shook on the deal.

And so, Rosie the raccoon helped Lia get as many berries as she wanted, and Lia provided a nice, cozy place in her den for Rosie to stay during the Winter.

When winter came, and Lia went to her den for hibernation, she thought about her new friendship with Rosie, and realized that often, someone couldn't do something alone. She was thankful for Rosie and was happy to make the agreement with her.

LEVEL 1

HOW TO DRAW A BOAT

